

0.0.1 Foremost Knowledge

1. Thus was heard by me. On one occasion the Auspicious One was dwelling in Savatthi at the Eastern Monastery, the mansion of Migara's Mother. At that time Vasettha and Bharadvaja were living on probation among the bhikkhus, wishing to become bhikkhus. Then in the evening, the Auspicious One, having emerged from seclusion, having descended from the palace, was walking up and down in the open air in the shade of the palace. Vasettha saw that the Auspicious One, having emerged from seclusion, having descended from the palace, was walking up and down in the open air in the shade of the palace. Having seen, he address Bharadvaja: "This Auspicious One, O friend Bharadvaja, having emerged from seclusion, having descended from the palace, is walking up and down in the open air in the shade of the palace. Let us approach this Auspicious One, O friend Bharadvaja. Hopefully, we might gain the hearing of a Dhamma talk in the presence of the Auspicious One." "Yes, friend," Bharadvaja replied to Vasettha. So then Vasettha and Bharadvaja approached the Auspicious One. Having approached, having bowed down to the Auspicious One, they walk back and forth following the Auspicious One.

2. Then the Auspicious One addressed Vasettha: "Here Vasettha, being brahmin by birth, of a brahmin caste, you have gone forth from the home life into homelessness from a brahmin family. Hopefully, O Vasettha, the brahmins do not abuse you with verbal abuse." "Certainly,

0.0.1 aggaññasuttam

1. evaṃ me sutam: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā sāvatthiyaṃ viharati pubbārāme migāramātupāsāde. tena kho pana samayena vāsetṭhabhāradvājā bhikkhūsu parivasanti¹ bhikkhubhāvaṃ ākaṅkhamānā. atha kho bhagavā sāyaṇhasamayaṃ paṭisallānā vuṭṭhito pāsādā orohitvā pāsādapacchāyāyaṃ² abbhokāse caṅkamati. addasā kho vāsetṭho bhagavantam sāyaṇhasamayaṃ paṭisallānā vuṭṭhitam pāsādā orohitvā pāsādapacchāyāyaṃ abbhokāse caṅkamantam. disvāna bhāradvājaṃ āmantesi: “ayaṃ āvuso bhāradvāja bhagavā sāyaṇhasamayaṃ paṭisallānā vuṭṭhito pāsādā orohitvā pāsādapacchāyāyaṃ abbhokāse caṅkamati. āyāmāvuso bhāradvāja yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkamissāma. appevanāma labheyyāma bhagavato santikā³ dhammiṃ katham savaṇāyā”ti. ‘evamāvuso’ti kho bhāradvājo vāsetṭhassa paccassosi. atha kho vāsetṭhabhāradvājā yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkamaṃsu. upasaṅkamitvā bhagavantam abhivādetvā bhagavantam caṅkamantam anucaṅkamaṃsu.

2. atha kho bhagavā vāsetṭham āmantesi: ‘tumhe khvattha vāsetṭhā, brāhmaṇajaccā brāhmaṇakulīnā brāhmaṇakulā agāasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajitā. kacci vo vāsetṭhā, brāhmaṇā na akkosanti na paribhāsanti?ti. “taggha no bhante, brāhmaṇā akkosanti paribhāsanti attarūpāya paribhāsāya paripuṇṇāya no aparipuṇṇāyā?ti”.

O Bhante, the brahmins fully abuse and insult us with personally suitable verbal abuse without holding back.”

3. “But in which way, O Vasettha, do the brahmins fully abuse and insult you with personally suitable verbal abuse without holding back?” “The brahmins, O Bhante, say thus: “The brahmins are the only most excellent caste, other castes are inferior. The brahmins are the only bright caste, other castes are dark. The brahmins are the only well-born, not non-brahmins. The brahmins are the only legitimate sons of Brahma, born of his mouth, born of Brahma, created by Brahma, an heir of Brahma. You, having abandoned the most excellent caste, have entered into an inferior caste, that of the shaven-headed counterfeit samanas, those dark menial offsprings of our kinsmen’s feet. This is not good, this is not proper, that you, having abandoned the most excellent caste, have entered into an inferior caste, that of the shaven-headed counterfeit samanas, those dark menial offsprings of our kinsmen’s feet.” Thus do the brahmins fully abuse and insult us with personally suitable verbal abuse without holding back?”

4. Certainly, O Vasettha, the brahmins do not remember their ancestry when they say thus to you: “The brahmins are the only most excellent caste, other castes are inferior. The brahmins are the only bright caste, other castes are dark. The brahmins are the only well-born, not non-brahmins. The brahmins are the only legitimate

3. “yathā katham pana vo vāseṭṭhā, brāhmaṇā akkosanti paribhāsanti attarūpāya paribhāsāya paripuṇṇāya no aparipuṇṇāyā?ti”. brāhmaṇā bhante evamāhaṃsu: “brāhmaṇo’va seṭṭho vaṇṇo hīnā aññe vaṇṇā brāhmaṇo’va sukko vaṇṇo, kaṇhā aññe vaṇṇā¹. brāhmaṇā’va sujjhanti no abrāhmaṇā brāhmaṇā’va brahmuno puttā orasā mukhato jātā brahmajā brahmanimmitā brahmadāyādā. te tumhe seṭṭham vaṇṇam hitvā hīnamattha vaṇṇam ajjhupagatā, yadidaṃ muṇḍake samaṇake ibbhe kaṇhe bandhupādāpacce. tayidaṃ na sādhu, tayidaṃ nappatirūpaṃ, yaṃ tumhe seṭṭham vaṇṇam hitvā hīnamattha vaṇṇam ajjhupagatā, yadidaṃ muṇḍake samaṇake ibbhe kaṇhe bandhupādāpacce”ti. evaṃ kho no bhante brāhmaṇā akkosanti paribhāsanti attarūpāya paribhāsāya paripuṇṇāya no aparipuṇṇāyā”ti.

4. “taggha vo vāseṭṭhā brāhmaṇā porāṇaṃ asarantā evamāhaṃsu: brāhmaṇo’va seṭṭho vaṇṇo, hīnā aññe vaṇṇā. brāhmaṇo va sukko vaṇṇo, kaṇhā aññe vaṇṇā, brāhmaṇā’va sujjhanti no abrāhmaṇā, brāhmaṇā’va brahmuno puttā orasā mukhato jātā brāhmajā brahmanimmitā brahmadāyādā”ti. dissanti kho pana vāseṭṭhā brāhmaṇānaṃ brāhmaṇiyo utuniyo’pi gabbhiniyo’pi vijāyamānā’pi pāyamānā’pi. te ca brāhmaṇā yonijā’va samānā evamāhaṃsu: brāhmaṇo’va seṭṭho vaṇṇo -pe- puttā orasā -pe- brahmadāyādā”ti. te ca brahmānañceva abbhācikkhanti musā ca bhāsanti bahuñca apuññaṃ pasavanti.

sons of Brahma, born of his mouth, born of Brahma, created by Brahma, an heir of Brahma.” Yet, O Vasettha, for the brahmins, the brahmin women are also seen menstruating, also being pregnant, also giving birth, also breastfeeding. Yet those brahmins, evidently being born from womb, say thus: The brahmins are the only most excellent caste, other castes are inferior. The brahmins are the only bright caste, other castes are dark. The brahmins are the only well-born, not non-brahmins. The brahmins are the only legitimate sons of Brahma, born of his mouth, born of Brahma, created by Brahma, an heir of Brahma.” Those brahmins simply misrepresent Brahma with untrue statements and accumulate much demerit.

5. There are, O Vasettha, these four castes, the Khattiya, the Brahmin, the Vessa and the Sudda. Here, O Vasettha, a certain khattiya is a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech, a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view. Thus, O Vasettha, these dhammas which are unwholesome and reckoned as unwholesome, blameworthy and reckoned as blameworthy, not to be associated with and reckoned as not to be associated with, unsuitable for the noble ones and reckoned as unsuitable for the noble ones, dark with dark results, blamed by the wise, a khattiya is seen engaging in them. Here, O Vasettha, a certain brahmin

5. cattāro' me vāsetṭha vaṇṇā, khattiyā brāhmaṇā vessā suddā. khattiyo'pi kho vāsetṭhā, idhekacco pāṇātipātī hoti adinnādāyī kāmesu micchācārī musāvādī pisuṇavāco pharusavāco samphappalāpī abhijjhālu byāpannacitto micchādiṭṭhī. iti kho vāsetṭha, ye' me dhammā akusalā akusalasaṅkhātā sāvajjā sāvajjasāṅkhātā asevitabbā asevitabbasaṅkhātā na alamariyā na alamariyasaṅkhātā, kaṇhā kaṇhavipākā viññugarahitā, khattiye pi te idhekacce sandissanti. brāhmaṇo pi kho vāsetṭha -pe- vesso pi kho vāsetṭha -pe- suddo pi kho vāsetṭha idhekacco pāṇātipātī hoti adinnādāyī -pe- micchādiṭṭhī. iti kho vāsetṭha, ye' me dhammā akusalā akusalasaṅkhātā -pe- kaṇhā kaṇhavipākā viññugarahitā, sudde pi te idhekacce sandissanti.

6. khattiyo pi kho vāsetṭha, idhekacco pāṇātipātā paṭivirato hoti. adinnādānā paṭivirato, kāmesu micchācārā paṭivirato, musāvādā paṭivirato, pisuṇāya vācāya paṭivirato, pharusāya vācāya paṭivirato, samphappalāpā paṭivirato, anabhijjhālu abyāpannacitto sammādiṭṭhī. iti kho vāsetṭhā, ye' me dhammā kusalā kusalasaṅkhātā anavajjā anavajjasāṅkhātā sevitabbā sevitabbasaṅkhātā alamariyā alamariyasaṅkhātā sukkā sukkavipākā viññuppasatthā, khattiye pi te vāsetṭhā idhekacce sandissanti. brāhmaṇo pi kho vāsetṭhā, -pe- vesso pi kho vāsetṭhā -pe- suddo pi kho vāsetṭhā idhekacco pāṇātipātā paṭivirato hoti -pe- anabhijjhālu abyāpannacitto sammādiṭṭhī. iti kho vāsetṭhā, ye' me dhammā kusalā kusalasaṅkhātā anavajjā anavajjasāṅkhātā sevitabbā sevitabbasaṅkhātā alamariyā alama-

too is a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech, a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view. Thus, O Vasettha, these dhammas which are unwholesome and reckoned as unwholesome, blameworthy and reckoned as blameworthy, not to be associated with and reckoned as not to be associated with, unsuitable for the noble ones and reckoned as unsuitable for the noble ones, dark with dark results, blamed by the wise, a brahmin too is seen engaging in them. Here, O Vasettha, a certain vessa too is a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech, a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view. Thus, O Vasettha, these dhammas which are unwholesome and reckoned as unwholesome, blameworthy and reckoned as blameworthy, not to be associated with and reckoned as not to be associated with, unsuitable for the noble ones and reckoned as unsuitable for the noble ones, dark with dark results, blamed by the wise, a vessa too is seen engaging in them. Here, O Vasettha, a certain sudda too is a killer of living beings, a taker of what is not given, an engager in misconduct in sensual pleasures, a speaker of falsehood, a speaker of divisive speech, a speaker of harsh speech, a covetous one, one with a mind of ill-will, a holder of wrong view. Thus, O Vasettha, these dhammas which are unwholesome and reckoned as unwholesome, blameworthy and

riyasaṅkhātā sukkā sukkavipākā viññuppasatthā, 1 sud-
depi te idhekacce sandissanti.

7. imesu kho vāsetṭhā, catusu vaṇṇesu evaṃ ubha-
yavokiṇṇesu vattamānesu kaṇhasukkesu dhammesu
viññugarahitesu ceva viññuppasatthesu ca. yadettha
brāhmaṇā evamāhaṃsu: brāhmaṇo'va seṭṭho vaṇṇo
hīnā aññe vaṇṇā. brāhmaṇo'va sukko vaṇṇo kaṇhā
aññe vaṇṇā, brāhmaṇā'va sujjhanti no abrāhmaṇā, brā-
hmaṇā'va brahmuno puttā orasā mukhato jātā brahmajā
brahmanimmitā brahmadāyādā"ti. taṃ tesam viññū
nānujānanti. taṃ kissa hetu? imesaṃ hi vāsetṭhā, ca-
tunnaṃ vaṇṇānaṃ yo hoti bhikkhu araham khīṇāsavo
vositavā katakaraṇīyo ohitabhāro anuppattasadattho
parikkhīṇabhavasamyojano sammadaññāvimutto, so
nesaṃ² aggamakkhāyati. dhammeneva no adhammena.
dhammo hi vāsetṭhā seṭṭho janetasmim diṭṭhe ceva
dhamme abhisamparāyeca³.

8. tadamināpetam vāsetṭhā, pariyāyena veditabbaṃ
yathā dhammova seṭṭho janetasmim diṭṭhe ceva dhamme
abhisamparāye¹ca. jānāti kho pana vāsetṭhā, rājā pa-
senadi kosalo "samaṇo gotamo anuttaro sakyakulā pab-
bajito"ti. sakyā kho pana vāsetṭhā, rañño pasenadino
kosalassa anantarā anuyuttā bhavanti. karonti kho
vāsetṭhā, sakyā raññe pasenadimhi kosale nipaccakā-
raṃ abhivādanaṃ paccuṭṭhānaṃ añjalikammaṃ sāmī-
cikaṃmaṃ. iti kho vāsetṭhā, yaṃ karonti sakyā raññe
pasenadimhi kosale nipaccakāraṃ abhivādanaṃ pac-
cuṭṭhānaṃ añjalikammaṃ sāmīcikaṃmaṃ, karoti taṃ

reckoned as blameworthy, not to be associated with and reckoned as not to be associated with, unsuitable for the noble ones and reckoned as unsuitable for the noble ones, dark with dark results, blamed by the wise, a sudda too is seen engaging in them.

6. Here, O Vasettha, a certain khattiya is an abstainer from the killing of living beings, an abstainer from the taking of what is not given, an abstainer from misconduct in sensual pleasures, an abstainer from false speech, an abstainer from divisive speech, an abstainer from harsh speech, an abstainer from senseless prattle, not covetous, one of a benevolent mind, one of right view. Thus, O Vasettha, these dhammas which are wholesome and reckoned as wholesome, blameless and reckoned as blameless, to be associated with and reckoned as to be associated with, suitable for the noble ones and reckoned as suitable for the noble ones. bright with bright results, praised by the wise, a khattiya is seen engaging in them. Here, O Vasettha, a certain brahmin too is an abstainer from the killing of living beings, an abstainer from the taking of what is not given, an abstainer from misconduct in sensual pleasures, an abstainer from false speech, an abstainer from divisive speech, an abstainer from harsh speech, an abstainer from senseless prattle, not covetous, one of a benevolent mind, one of right view. Thus, O Vasettha, these dhammas which are wholesome and reckoned as wholesome, blameless and reckoned as blameless, to be associated with and reckoned as to

rājā pasenadi kosalo tathāgate nipaccakāraṃ abhivādanam paccuṭṭhānaṃ añjalikammaṃ sāmīcīkammaṃ. nanu² ‘sujāto samaṇo gotamo, dujjāto³’hamasmi, balavā samaṇo gotamo dubbalo’hamasmi, pāsādiko samaṇo gotamo dubbaṇṇo’hamasmi, mahesakkho samaṇo gotamo, appesakkho’hamasmi”ti. atha kho naṃ dhammaṃ yeva sakkaronto dhammaṃ garukaronto dhammaṃ mānento dhammaṃ pūjento dhammaṃ apacāya-māno evaṃ rājā pasenadi kosalo tathāgate nipaccakāraṃ karoti abhivādanam paccuṭṭhānaṃ añjalikammaṃ sāmīcīkammaṃ.

9. iminā’pi kho etaṃ vāseṭṭhā, pariyāyena veditabbaṃ yathā dhammo’va seṭṭho jane’tasmiṃ diṭṭhe ceva dhamme abhisamparāye¹ca. tumhe khvattha vāseṭṭhā nānājaccā nānānāmā nānāgottā nānākulā agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajitā. ‘ke tumhe?’ti puṭṭhā samānā, ‘samaṇā sakyaputtiyamhā’ti paṭijānātha. yassa kho panassa vāseṭṭhā, tathāgate saddhā nivīṭṭhā mūlajātā patitṭhitā daḥhā asaṃhāriyā⁴ samaṇena vā brāhmaṇena vā devena vā mārena vā brahmunā vā kenaci vā lokasmiṃ, tassetam kallaṃ vacanāya: bhagavato’mhi putto oraso mukhato jāto dhammajō dhammanimmitto dhammadāyādo’ti. taṃ kissa hetu? tathāgatassa etaṃ vāseṭṭhā adhivacanam dhammakāyo iti pi, brahmakāyo iti pi, dhammabhūto iti pi, brahmbhūto iti pi.

be associated with, suitable for the noble ones and reckoned as suitable for the noble ones, bright with bright results, praised by the wise, a brahmin is seen engaging in them. Here, O Vasettha, a certain vessa too is an abstainer from the killing of living beings, an abstainer from the taking of what is not given, an abstainer from misconduct in sensual pleasures, an abstainer from false speech, an abstainer from divisive speech, an abstainer from harsh speech, an abstainer from senseless prattle, not covetous, one of a benevolent mind, one of right view. Thus, O Vasettha, these dhammas which are wholesome and reckoned as wholesome, blameless and reckoned as blameless, to be associated with and reckoned as to be associated with, suitable for the noble ones and reckoned as suitable for the noble ones, bright with bright results, praised by the wise, a vessa is seen engaging in them. Here, O Vasettha, a certain sudda too is an abstainer from the killing of living beings, an abstainer from the taking of what is not given, an abstainer from misconduct in sensual pleasures, an abstainer from false speech, an abstainer from divisive speech, an abstainer from harsh speech, an abstainer from senseless prattle, not covetous, one of a benevolent mind, one of right view. Thus, O Vasettha, these dhammas which are wholesome and reckoned as wholesome, blameless and reckoned as blameless, to be associated with and reckoned as to be associated with, suitable for the noble ones and reckoned as suitable for the noble ones, bright with bright results, praised by the wise, a sudda is seen engaging in them.

7. With both dark and bright dhammas existing thus, O Vasettha, both-ways mixed among these four castes, [both what is] blamed by the wise and praised by the wise, of which here the brahmins say thus: “The brahmins are the only most excellent caste, other castes are inferior. The brahmins are the only bright caste, other castes are dark. The brahmins are the only well-born, not non-brahmins. The brahmins are the only legitimate sons of Brahma, born of his mouth, born of Brahma, created by Brahma, an heir of Brahma.” that the wise do not agree. What is the reason for that? Because, O Vasetṭha, whichever bhikkhu of the four castes is an arahant with asavas extincted, one who has lived [the life of purity], done what must be done, laid down the burden, attained the true advantage, completely extincted the fetters of being, one who is liberated by right final knowledge, he is said to be the foremost of them according to Dhamma, not non-Dhamma. Indeed Dhamma, O Vasetthā, is simply the best cause of birth in this world and the next.

8. By this method, O Vasettha, it is to be known how the Dhamma is simply the best cause of birth in this world and the next. King Pasenadi of Kosala knows well, O Vasettha: “The samana Gotama who has gone forth from a Sakyan family, is superior.” But the Sakyans, O vāsetṭhā, exist as subordinate followers of King Pasenadi of Kosala. They, the Sakyans, O Vasettha, perform acts of submission to King Pasenadi of Kosala, bowing down, rising from their seats [as a token of respect], doing rever-

ential salutations and paying homage. Thus, O Vasettha, those acts of submission which they, the Sakyans, perform to King Pasenadi of Kosala, bowing down, rising from their seats [as a token of respect], doing reverential salutations and paying homage, it is those [same acts] that King Pasenadi of Kosala, perform towards the Tathagata, bowing down, rising from his seat [as a token of respect], doing reverential salutations and paying homage, [thinking]: “Certainly the samana Gotama is well-born, while I am ill-born, the samana Gotama is powerful, while I am powerless, the samana Gotama is elegant, while I am ugly, the samana Gotama is of great influence, while I am of little influence.” Now for him it is only by honoring the Dhamma, respecting the Dhamma, revering the Dhamma, worshipping the Dhamma, esteeming the Dhamma, that King Pasenadi of Kosala, perform such acts of submission towards the Tathagata, bowing down, rising from his seat [as a token of respect], doing reverential salutations and paying homage.

9. By this method too, O Vasettha, it is to be known how the Dhamma is simply the best cause of birth in this world and the next. All of you here, O Vasettha, of various births, various names, various lineages, various families, have gone forth from home life into homelessness. When being asked: “Who are you?” you should acknowledge: “We are samanas, sons of the Sakyan.” Of whom, O Vasettha, faith in the Tathagata is settled, rooted, established, firm, unshakeable by any samana

or brahmana or deva or mara or Brahma or anyone in the world, this is fitting for him to say: “I am truly the legitimate son of the Auspicious One, born of his mouth, born of the Dhamma, created by the Dhamma, an heir of the Dhamma.” What is the reason for that? Because, O Vasettha, this is the designation for the Tathagata: “An embodiment of Dhamma.” Also “An embodiment of Brahma.” Also “A Dhamma Being.” Also “A Brahma Being.”

